

PLUGIN_TROUBLESHOOTING

qBittorrent Search Plugin Troubleshooting Guide

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This guide covers common issues with search plugins and their solutions.

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Known Issues

Issue 1: Downloads Don't Start from Search (WebUI Only)

Symptom: You search for torrents using RuTracker or other private trackers, find results, click download, but the torrent never appears in the download list.

Root Cause: qBittorrent WebUI has a fundamental limitation where it does NOT use `nova2dl.py` for downloading torrents from search results. Instead, it tries to download the torrent URL directly, which fails for private trackers that require authentication.

Affected Plugins: - RuTracker (requires login) - Kinozal (requires login) - NNMClub (requires login) - Rutor (works with magnet links)

Solutions:

Option A: Use qBittorrent Desktop Application (Recommended)

The desktop app properly uses nova2dl.py which handles authentication:

```
# Install plugins for desktop app
./install-plugin.sh --local rutor
```

Option B: Use Magnet Links Instead

Configure Rutor plugin to return magnet links instead of .torrent files:

```
# Edit .env file
RUTOR_USE_MAGNET=true
```

Option C: Manual Download

1. Search for torrents in WebUI
2. Note the torrent name/size
3. Go to the tracker website directly
4. Download the .torrent file manually
5. Add it to qBittorrent via “Upload local torrent” button

Option D: Use Alternative Trackers

Rutor works best with WebUI because it provides magnet links that don’t require authentication.

Issue 2: Only RuTracker Plugin Visible

Symptom: In the Search > Search Plugins section, only RuTracker appears even though all 4 plugins should be installed.

Root Causes: 1. Plugins not properly copied to the container 2. File permissions incorrect 3. Container not restarted after plugin installation 4. Plugin syntax errors

Solutions:

Step 1: Verify Plugin Installation

```
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

This will check: - All plugin files exist - Files have correct permissions - Python syntax is valid

Step 2: Reinstall All Plugins

```
# Reinstall all plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# Verify installation
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

Step 3: Check Container Plugins

```
# For Podman
podman exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/

# For Docker
docker exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/
```

You should see all 4 plugin files: - rutracker.py - rutor.py - kinozal.py - nmclub.py

Step 4: Restart Container

```
# For Podman
podman restart qbittorrent

# For Docker
docker restart qbittorrent
```

Step 5: Refresh WebUI

After restarting, hard-refresh the WebUI page (Ctrl+Shift+R or Cmd+Shift+R).

Quick Fixes

Fix All Issues at Once

```
# 1. Stop container
./stop.sh
```

```
# 2. Reinstall all plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# 3. Verify installation
./install-plugin.sh --verify

# 4. Start container
./start.sh

# 5. Wait for container to be ready, then refresh WebUI
sleep 5
```

Run All Tests

```
# Test plugin installation and structure
python3 -m pytest tests/unit/ --import-mode=importlib

# Test download functionality
python3 tests/test_download_comprehensive.py
```

WebUI vs Desktop App

WebUI Limitations

The qBittorrent WebUI has a fundamental limitation with search plugin downloads:

WebUI Search Flow:

1. User searches → WebUI calls plugin's search() method ✓ Works
2. User clicks download → WebUI sends URL to /api/v2/torrents/add x Problem!
3. Backend tries to download URL directly x No authentication!
4. Download fails for private trackers x

Desktop App Flow:

1. User searches → App calls plugin's search() method ✓ Works
2. User clicks download → App calls nova2dl.py ✓ Correct!
3. nova2dl.py uses plugin's download_torrent() method ✓ Authenticated!
4. Download succeeds ✓

Recommendations

Use Case	Recommended Approach
	Use Desktop App or manual download

Use Case	Recommended Approach
Private trackers (RuTracker, Kinozal, NNMClub)	
Public trackers with magnets (Rutor)	Works with both WebUI and Desktop
Automation/Remote access	Use magnet links where possible

Plugin Installation

Install All Plugins

```
./install-plugin.sh --all
```

Install Specific Plugin

```
./install-plugin.sh rutracker
```

Install Locally (Desktop App)

```
./install-plugin.sh --local rutracker
```

Verify Installation

```
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

Test Plugins

```
./install-plugin.sh --test
```

Download Issues

Testing Download Functionality

Test via nova2dl.py (Command Line)

```
# Test RuTracker download (works with authentication)
podman exec -u abc qbittorrent \
  python3 /config/qBittorrent/nova3/nova2dl.py \
  rutracker 'https://rutracker.org/forum/dl.php?t=6782121'
```

```
# Expected output:  
# /tmp/rutracker_xxx.torrent https://rutracker.org/forum/dl.php?  
t=6782121
```

Test Plugin Directly

```
# Test RuTracker plugin  
python3 plugins/rutracker.py
```

Common Download Errors

“Unable to connect using given credentials”

- Check your RuTracker username/password in .env file
- Verify credentials work on rutracker.org website
- Check if RuTracker is accessible (try different mirrors)

“No data received from URL”

- The torrent might have been removed
- Try a different torrent
- Check if you have permission to access the torrent

“Received HTML page instead of torrent file”

- Authentication failed
- Your session might have expired
- Try restarting the container

Debugging Steps

Enable Debug Logging

For RuTracker Plugin

Edit plugins/rutracker.py and change:

```
logging.basicConfig(level=logging.WARNING)
```

to:

```
logging.basicConfig(level=logging.DEBUG)
```

For Container

```
# View container logs
podman logs -f qbittorrent
```

```
# Or
docker logs -f qbittorrent
```

Check Plugin Status via API

```
# Get list of installed plugins
curl -X POST \
  http://localhost:7186/api/v2/auth/login \
  -d "username=admin&password=admin"

curl -X GET \
  http://localhost:7186/api/v2/search/plugins \
  -b "SID=your_session_id"
```

Manual Plugin Testing

```
# Test plugin directly
import sys
sys.path.insert(0, 'plugins')
from rutracker import RuTracker

# Create instance
engine = RuTracker()

# Test search
engine.search("ubuntu")
print(f"Found {len(engine.results)} results")

# Test download (if results found)
if engine.results:
    first = list(engine.results.values())[0]
    engine.download_torrent(first['link'])
```

Check File Permissions

```
# Check plugin files in container
podman exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/

# Should show:
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc rutracker.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc rutor.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc kinozal.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc nnmclub.py
```

Reset Everything

If nothing else works, reset the entire setup:

```
# 1. Stop and remove container
./stop.sh -r

# 2. Remove config (WARNING: This removes all settings!)
rm -rf config/qBittorrent

# 3. Reinstall plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# 4. Start fresh
./start.sh
```

FAQ

Q: Why do magnet links work but .torrent files don't?

A: Magnet links don't require authentication to the tracker. They're just a URL that qBittorrent can handle directly. .torrent files from private trackers require you to be logged in to download them.

Q: Can I fix the WebUI to use nova2dl.py?

A: This would require modifying qBittorrent's core code. The WebUI is designed to work with magnet links and public trackers. For private trackers, use the desktop app.

Q: Do I need credentials for all plugins?

A: - **RuTracker:** Yes, requires username/password - **Rutor:** No, works without authentication - **Kinozal:** Yes, requires username/password - **NNMClub:** Yes, requires cookies

Q: How do I get NNMClub cookies?

A: 1. Login to nnmclub.to in your browser 2. Open browser developer tools (F12) 3. Go to Application/Storage > Cookies 4. Copy the cookie string 5. Add to .env: NNMCLUB_COOKIES="name1=value1; name2=value2"

Q: Can I use a proxy?

A: Yes, some plugins support proxies:

```
# For Rutor
RUTOR_PROXY_ENABLED=true
RUTOR_PROXY_HTTP=http://proxy:8080
RUTOR_PROXY_HTTPS=https://proxy:8080
```

Getting Help

If you're still having issues:

1. Run the test suite: `python3 -m pytest tests/unit/ --import-mode=importlib`
2. Check container logs: `podman logs qbittorrent`
3. Enable debug logging in plugins
4. Check qBittorrent's official documentation: <https://wiki.qbittorrent.org/>

Summary

Issue	Quick Fix
Downloads don't start	Use desktop app or magnet links
Only RuTracker visible	Run <code>./install-plugin.sh --all</code> and restart container
Plugin errors	Run <code>./install-plugin.sh --verify</code>
Authentication failed	Check credentials in <code>.env</code> file
Slow downloads	Try different mirrors or use proxy

Remember: The fundamental limitation is that WebUI cannot download from private trackers directly. Use the desktop app or magnet links as workarounds.